

CROCUS

deep violet-purple with white margins outside. Z4-8

C. laevigatus. Very variable corm, flowering intermittently for a month or more in fall or winter depending on the form. Fragrant flowers are borne with leaves and are usually lilac-purple with bold stripes on outside; inside each has a yellow eye and cream-white anthers. Z8-10

C. ligusticus, syn. *C. medius*. Fall-flowering corm. Has 1 or 2 funnel-shaped, uniform rich purple flowers, with yellow anthers and red stigmas cut into many threadlike branches. Leaves are produced in winter-spring, after flowering. Z5-9

C. longiflorus. Fall-flowering corm. Produces 1 or 2, strongly fragrant, slender, purple flowers, which are striped darker purple outside, at the same time as leaves. Flowers have yellow centers and anthers and red stigmas. Z5-9

C. x luteus ‘Golden Yellow’, syn. *C. ‘Dutch Yellow’*, *C. ‘Golden Yellow’*. Very vigorous, clump-forming, spring-flowering corm. Bears 2-5 orange-yellow flowers, faintly striped outside at bases. Naturalizes well in grass. Z5-9

C. malyi. Spring-flowering corm with slightly gray-green leaves. Bears 1 or 2 funnel-shaped, white flowers with yellow throats, brown or purple tubes and showy, bright orange stigmas. Z5-9

C. medius. See *C. ligusticus*.

C. minimus. Late spring-flowering corm. Produces 1 or 2 long-tubed, mid- to deep lilac purple flowers. Outer petals are veined, stained or feathered with dark violet, often on a buff or yellow base. Z4-10

C. niveus. Fall-flowering corm. Produces 1 or 2 flowers, varying from white to lilac with yellow throats, and with long, white, yellow, or purple-brown tubes. Conspicuous, orange styles are much-divided. Leaves emerge with flowers or just afterward. Needs a warm, sunny site. Z5-9

C. nudiflorus (Autumn crocus). Fall-flowering corm. Usually bears one slender, long-tubed, rich purple flower, with a frilly, bright orange or yellow stigma. Leaves are produced after the flowers. Naturalizes in grass. Z4-8

C. olivieri. Spring-flowering corm with spreading leaves. Produces 1-4, long-tubed, pale lemon yellow to deep orange flowers, with undivided styles. Z5-9. Flowers of **subsp. balansae** (syn. *C. balansae*) are stained or striped bronze-brown outside.

C. pulchellus. Fall- to early-winter-flowering corm. Bears 1, rarely 2, long-tubed, goblet-shaped, pale lilac-blue flowers with darker veins, conspicuous, yellow throats and white anthers, before the leaves. Z5-9

C. salzmannii. See *C. serotinus* subsp. *salzmannii*.

C. sativus, syn. *C.s.* var. *cashmirianus* (Saffron crocus). Fall-flowering corm. Dull green leaves are produced at the same time as 1-5, widely open, rich violet flowers, with dark purple veins. Each flower has 3 long, bright red stigmas that yield saffron. Z6-8

C. serotinus subsp. salzmannii, syn. *C. salzmannii*. Fall-flowering corm. Produces large, solitary, lilac-blue flowers, sometimes with yellow throats, as leaves are just starting to emerge. Z6-8

C. sieberi. Vigorous, late winter to early spring-flowering corm. Bears scented, rich pinkish-lilac to blue, yellow-throated flowers. Z4-8. **‘Albus’** (syn. *C.s.* ‘Bowles’ White’) illus. p.427. **subsp. atticus** has pale lilac to violet-blue flowers with frilly, orange stigmas. **‘Bowles’ White’** see. *C.s.* ‘Albus’. **‘Firefly’** has abundant lilac flowers. **‘Hubert Edelsten’** (illus p.417) has yellow-throated, pale lilac flowers, the outer segments of which are white, tipped, centrally marked and feathered with rich purple. **subsp. sublimis f. tricolor** (illus. p.417) has unusual flowers, divided into 3 distinct bands of lilac, white, and golden yellow.

C. ‘Snow Bunting’ (illus. p.417). Spring-flowering corm. Fragrant, long-tubed, funnel-shaped, white flowers are lightly feathered gray-blue outside, with mustard-yellow centers and orange stigmas. Z4-8

C. speciosus (illus. p.417). Fall-flowering corm. Bears solitary, lilac-blue to deep purple-blue flowers, usually with a network of darker veins and a much-divided, orange stigma. Leaves emerge in winter-spring. Z4-8. **‘Albus’** see *C.s. f. albus. f. albus* (syn. *C.s.* ‘Albus’) has pure white flowers. **‘Conqueror’** (illus. p.417) has large, deep sky-blue flowers. **‘Oxonian’** produces dark violet-blue flowers with prominent darker veining on the outside.

C. susianus. See *C. angustifolius*.

C. tommasinianus. Late winter to spring-flowering corm. Bears 1 or 2 slender, long-tubed, funnel-shaped flowers, varying in color from lilac or purple to violet, sometimes with darker tips to petals and occasionally silver outside. Naturalizes well. Z4-8. **f. albus** has white flowers. **‘Barr’s Purple’** has purple flowers, silvery outside. **‘Ruby Giant’** (illus. p.417) is clump-forming, bearing clusters of large rich reddish-purple flowers. **‘Whitewell Purple’** increases rapidly, and has slender, reddish-purple flowers, silver-mauve inside.

C. tournefortii. Late fall- to early winter-flowering corm. Leaves emerge at same time as 1 or 2 long-tubed, widely open, pale lilac-blue flower, each with a much-divided, orange stigma and white anthers. Remains open at night. Needs a sunny site. Z8-10

C. vernus (Dutch crocus, Spring crocus). Spring- to early summer-flowering corm. Produces solitary flowers in white, or shades of purple or lilac, often striped and feathered. Stigmas are large, frilly and orange or yellow. Suitable for naturalizing. Z3-8. **subsp. albiflorus** has small, white flowers, sometimes slightly marked or striped purple. **‘Jeanne d’Arc’** produces white flowers with a deep purple base. **‘Pickwick’** (illus. p.417) bears pale, grayish-white flowers, with dark violet stripes and purplish bases. **‘Purpureus Grandiflorus’** has shiny, violet-purple flowers. **‘Queen of the Blues’** (illus. p.417) has rich blue flowers that have higher margins and a darker base. **‘Remembrance’** (illus. p.417) has shiny, violet flowers. **‘Vanguard’**, a very early cultivar, produces bluish-lilac flowers, paler and silvered outside.

C. ‘Zephyr’. Fall-flowering corm. Bears solitary, long-tubed, very pale silver-blue flowers, veined darker, each with a conspicuous yellow throat and white anthers, before the leaves. Z5-8

C. zonatus. See *C. kotschyanus*.

C. ‘Zwanenburg Bronze’, syn. *C. chrysanthus* ‘Zwanenberg Bronze’, (illus. p.417). Spring-flowering corm. Produces bicolored flowers, rich yellow inside, stained bronze outside. Z5-9

CROSSANDRA

ACANTHACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and subshrubs, grown mainly for their flowers. Needs partial shade or full light and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Water potted plants freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. For a strong branch system, cut back flowered growth by at least half in late winter. Propagate by seed in spring or by greenwood cuttings in late spring or summer. Whitefly may be troublesome.

C. infundibuliformis, syn. *C. undulifolia*. Evergreen, erect to spreading, soft-stemmed shrub or subshrub. H to 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Has ovate to lance-shaped, glossy, deep green leaves and, in summer-fall or earlier, fan-shaped, salmon-red flowers in conical spikes, each 4in (10cm) long. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

C. nilotica. Evergreen, upright to spreading, leafy shrub. H 12-24in (30-60cm), S to 14in (35cm). Has ovate, pointed, rich green leaves. Small tubular, apricot to pale brick-red flowers with spreading petals are borne in short spikes from spring to fall. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

C. undulifolia. See *C. infundibuliformis*.

CROTALARIA

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, perennials and annuals, grown mainly for their flowers. Requires full light and well-drained soil. Water containerized specimens freely when in full growth, less at other times. For a more compact habit, cut back old stems by half after flowering. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. Red spider mite may be troublesome.

C. agatiflora (Canary-bird bush) illus. p.459.

Crucianella. See *Phuopsis*.

CRUSEA

RUBIACEAE

Genus of annuals and perennials grown for their showy flowers. Needs a position in semi- to full shade in moist but well-drained, humus-rich soil. Propagate by seed in spring, by division in spring or summer or by cuttings in summer.

C. coccinea illus. p.268.

CRYPTANTHUS

BROMELIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, rosette-forming perennials, grown for their attractive foliage. Needs semishade and well-drained soil, preferably mixed with sphagnum moss. Water moderately in the growing season, sparingly at other times. Propagate by offsets or suckers in late spring.

C. acaulis (Green earth star). Evergreen, clump-forming, basal-rosetted perennial.

H to 4in (10cm), S 6-12in (15-30cm). Loose, flat rosettes of lance-shaped to narrowly triangular, wavy, mid-green leaves have serrated edges. Bears a cluster of fragrant, tubular, white flowers from rosette centers, usually in summer. Z12. (min. 68°F/20°C). **‘Ruber’** has red-flushed foliage.

C. bivittatus. Evergreen, clump-forming, basal-rosetted perennial. H to 6in (15cm), S 10-15in (25-38cm). Loose, flat rosettes of broadly lance-shaped, wavy, mid- to yellowish-green leaves have finely toothed margins and are striped lengthways with 2 coppery-fawn to buff bands. Small clusters of tubular, white flowers are produced from center of each rosette, usually in summer. Z12. (min. 68°F/20°C). **‘Pink Starlite’** (illus. p.471), H 8in (20cm) or more, S 14in (35cm) or more, is spreading, with strap-shaped, green leaves striped yellowish-green, and heavily suffused deep pink.

C. bromelioides (Rainbow star). Evergreen, spreading, basal-rosetted perennial. H 8in (20cm) or more, S 14in (35cm) or more. Has dense rosettes of strap-shaped, wavy, finely toothed, arching, mid- to bright green leaves. Occasionally bears clusters of tubular, white flowers in center of each rosette, usually in summer. Z12. (min. 68°F/20°C).

‘Tricolor’ has carmine-suffused, white-striped foliage.

C. zonatus. Evergreen, basal-rosetted perennial. H 4-6in (10-15cm), S 12-16in (30-40cm). Forms loose, flat rosettes of strap-shaped, wavy, finely toothed, sepia-green leaves, cross-banded with gray-buff and with grayish-white scales beneath. A cluster of tubular, white flowers opens in each rosette, usually in summer. Z12. (min. 68°F/20°C). **‘Zebrinus’** has silver-banded foliage.

CRYPTOCORYNE

ARACEAE

Genus of evergreen, marginal aquatic perennials, grown for their foliage. Suitable for tropical aquariums. Needs sun and rich soil. Remove fading foliage, and divide plants periodically. Propagate by division in spring or summer.

C. spiralis. Semievergreen, perennial, submerged water plant. S 6in (15cm). Small, hooded, purplish spathes are borne intermittently among lance-shaped, purplish-green leaves. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

CRYPTOGRAMMA

PTERIDACEAE

Genus of deciduous or semievergreen ferns. Needs partial shade and moist but well-drained, neutral or acidic soil. Remove fading fronds. Propagate by spores in late summer.

C. crispa (Parsley fern) illus. p.293.

CRYPTOMERIA

CUPRESSACEAE

See also CONIFERS.

C. japonica (Japanese cedar). Fast-growing, columnar to conical, open conifer. H 50-70ft (15-20m), S 15-25ft (5-8m). Has soft, fibrous, red-brown bark, needlelike, incurved, mid- to dark green leaves, spirally arranged, and globular, brown cones. Z5-9. **‘Bandai-sugi’**, H and S 6ft